

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Legal Assistant role in Russell Cooke's Private Client team appeals to me because it combines two things I have worked directly on: advising individuals on complex, sensitive matters and managing high volumes of documentation to tight deadlines. My LLM, my year at BCLP and my current role at Citizens Advice have each given me experience that maps closely onto what this role involves.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I advise clients across housing, welfare, debt and family matters, many of whom are in genuinely difficult circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, identify the relevant legal issues, draft correspondence and prepare document schedules, then manage the file through to submission. Working with vulnerable individuals has sharpened my ability to communicate clearly and sensitively while keeping matters on track, which is central to good private client work.

At BCLP, I spent six months in international arbitration and six months in real estate disputes. In the arbitration team, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery, which required the kind of careful, organised file management that a busy private client practice depends on. I also liaised with the client directly about required documents and coordinated external translators, so I have a working sense of what client-facing coordination looks like in a professional firm context.

My Italian is native level (I am a native Portuguese speaker and my Italian is at a comparable fluency, having spoken it throughout my education and family life), which I understand is a specific requirement for this team given its work with HNW and UHNW individuals and families. Being able to advise and correspond in Italian without an intermediary is something I can offer immediately.

Russell Cooke's reputation in private client work is specific enough that joining this team would mean working on genuinely complex matters for international clients from the outset. That is the context in which I want to develop, and I have the organisational and communication experience to contribute from day one.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva